

Response: Remember your mercy, Lord.

GOSPEL READING: Matthew 21: 28-32

Jesus said to the chief priests and the elders of the people:

‘What is your opinion? A man had two sons. He went and said to the first,

“My boy, you go and work in the vineyard today”.

He answered, “I will not go”, but afterwards thought better of it and went.

The man then went and said the same thing to the second who answered, *“Certainly, sir”, but did not go. Which of the two did the father’s will?’*

‘The first’ they said. Jesus said to them,

‘I tell you solemnly, tax collectors and prostitutes are making their way into the kingdom of God before

you. For John came to you, a pattern of true righteousness, but you did not believe him, and yet the tax collectors and prostitutes did. Even after seeing that, you refused to think better of it and believe in him’.



For this **112th World Day for Migrants and Refugees**, the theme, *“Even just one of these children,”* draws our attention to the minors directly involved in the experience of migration and flight, to the care owed to them, and to the Lord’s promise that *“whoever receives one such child in my name receives me”* (Mk 9:37). Minors are the most vulnerable group within the global movements of migration. They are concrete faces, who have unique stories, and call on our conscience. Every year, millions of children and adolescents are forced to leave their homeland because of war, poverty, violence, environmental disasters and other tragedies. Sadly, their number continues to grow. The economic, political and military consequences of this disaster are immense. The suffering of migrant children does not end with their relocation. There are very young children who have lost parents, brothers, sisters and friends, and who have witnessed unspeakable acts of violence. Others, separated from their families for long periods, try to reunite with them while enduring the anguish of separation. There are also minors who make the journey together with their parents, yet are exposed to extreme and traumatic conditions. Finally, we cannot forget the tragic situation of those separated from their parents because of repatriation. To this already appalling situation are added further tragedies: deaths along migration routes, trafficking and exploitation, the recruitment of minors for use in armed conflicts, sexual violence, forced marriages, and the atrocities they have suffered or witnessed during their travels. Their dignity is trampled upon in countless ways. In his message to mark World Day of Migrants and Refugees for 2017, Pope Francis recalled that migrant children *“in a threefold way are defenceless: they are children, they are foreigners, and they have no means to protect themselves. I ask everyone to help those who, for various reasons, are forced to live far from their homeland and are separated from their families.”*

Continued overleaf/....

SUNDAY REFLECTION ON THE READINGS

(Ezekiel 18:25-28; Philipians 2:1-11; Matthew 21:28-32).

Today’s readings bring us face to face with one of the most important truths in the spiritual life: *God is not impressed by empty words, but by converted lives.*

In the first reading, through the prophet Ezekiel, God speaks clearly: if the wicked person turns away from sin and does what is right, he will live; but if the righteous person turns away from righteousness and does evil, he will die. The message is simple: *what matters most is not where we started, but where we are going now.* God is always ready to forgive, always ready to restore, always ready to give a new beginning. No one is too far gone for mercy, and no one can boast as though they are already safe without perseverance.

St. Paul in the second reading gives us the beautiful model of this new life: Jesus Christ Himself. The road of Christian greatness must include humility, self-emptying, and obedience. In a world where people want to be seen, promoted, praised, and admired, Christ shows us another way - the way of service.

The Gospel then drives the lesson home with the parable of the two sons. One son said “No,” but later changed his mind and went. The other said “Yes,” but never went. Jesus asks the chief priests and elders a piercing question: *‘Which one did the will of the father?’* The answer is obvious: not the one who spoke nicely, but the one who actually obeyed.

This is a word for all of us. It is not enough to say “Lord, Lord.” It is not enough to make promises in prayer, at Mass, or in public. God wants action.

He wants conversion.

He wants obedience that shows up in daily life - in our homes, our work, our relationships, and our moral choices.

Peace be with you.

8.00am: Anna Devine (A)
10.00am: Alice Burke (B'day Rem)

8.00am: Angela Rea (9th A)
10.00am: Juan Goncalves (A)

8.00am: Manuel & Celira Cardoso (Thanksgiving)
10.00am: John Ward (A)

8.00am: No Intention **10.00am:** Rose Flaherty (A)
7.30pm Curry: No Intention

8.00am: No Intention
10.00am: Conor Molloy (Deceased)
7.30pm: No Intention

8.00am: No Intention
10.00am: Daniel Dennigan (A) & DFM

7.30pm Vigil: Annie Monks (A)
Mary & George Dowd & their sons Michael, Jimmy & Francie (A)

10.00am: Mary Henry (A)
Molly Lynch (A)
Mary Morgan (MM) & her son Brendan (A)

1.00pm: Dermott Gray, Marian Gray & Bridget Tyrell (A)
Martin Lowry (A)
Vincent & Sheila Crossan (A)

Yet, amid so much darkness, the light of solidarity is not lacking. Individuals, families, civil institutions and ecclesial communities choose ‘*not to pass by on the other side*’ (cf. Lk 10:29-37). We think of the families who open the doors of their homes in order to restore to these children the warmth of a family hearth; the educators who serve in reception centres; the volunteers and aid workers who each day devote themselves to healing the invisible wounds of these little ones along migration routes and in our cities. They bear witness through their commitment that love can overcome indifference.